

The Rich Quarter

Of the 365 crorepatis who contested the 2004 Lok Sabha elections, 135 got elected to the House of the

A PRABHAKAR RAO



D.K. Adikesavulu
Telugu Desam Party
Chittoor, Andhra Pradesh

Total Assets
Rs 66.9 cr

His penchant for molasses, produced in sugar factories, has propelled him to prosperity and power. Armed as a licentiate in mechanical engineering, he started out as a machine operator at the district cooperative sugar factory, near his Dalavai village, in the arid southernmost Chittoor district. But when he helped himself to molasses, sensing its monetary value if converted into rectified spirit to blend a range of liquors, DK, as he is known to close associates, had to quit the factory to open a couple of liquor shops in Bangalore. With that grew his ties with the UB Group to become a distributor and then

earn the epithet of liquor baron. As an active Congressman, he was close to P.V. Narasimha Rao and embroiled in the JMM bribery scandal. But he lost in his first attempt to get to the Lok Sabha on a Congress ticket in 1996. Soon spirits and spirituality became a heady cocktail that enabled him to become an influential manager of the Sri Sathya Sai

Trust and a member of the board of the Tirupathi Tirumala Devasthanams (TTD)—custodians of the richest place of worship in the world. With it came clout that made him get the coveted chairmanship of TTD first when N. Chandrababu Naidu was chief minister and, more recently, from Y.S.R. Reddy. This, as thanksgiving, for supporting the Manmohan Singh Government by switching loyalties having won the Chittoor Lok Sabha seat in 2004 on a TDP ticket. His Srinivasa Trust also provides potable water to 1,400 villages. *by Amarnath K. Menon*